

Birla Institute of Technology and Science, Pilani, Pilani Campus
Department of Humanities and Social Sciences
First Semester 2025-2026
Comprehensive Examination

Course No: GS F211

Course Title: Modern Political Concepts

Date & Time: 01/12/2025, FN

Marks: 40

Time: 3 Hours

Answer the following questions

1. Explain the tension between nature and society in Rousseau's anthropology and how does this tension inform his understanding of corruption and virtue? (7 Marks)
2. Analyze the role of print capitalism in the emergence of national consciousness. Is this explanation still relevant in the age of digital media? (7 Marks)
3. Examine the relationship between civil society and the state. Is civil society autonomous, complementary, or antagonistic to state power? Use examples from democratic and authoritarian contexts. (5 Marks)
4. Explain Rajeev Bhargava's concept of "principled distance" and examine how does it differentiate Indian model of secularism from the Western secularism. (5 Marks)
5. How do Hobbes, Aristotle, and Machiavelli differ in their assumptions about human nature, and how do these assumptions shape their respective visions of political authority and stability? (10 Marks)
6. What is deliberative democracy? How does it improvise the traditional model of democracy? (6 Marks)

